PANELTEC PTY LTD
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SWMS-61

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**Combination Vacuum Truck**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:** ______________		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023	______________	31/08/2025 – V12.0
Name	**Position**	☎	**Signature**	**Date**

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L *Likely*	M *Moderate*	U *Unlikely*
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people.** **Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Set out work area.	Struck by road or construction plant.	**1**	1. Barricade area off to restrict access and minimize plant working area as appropriate. 2. All workers to wear safety vests or high visible clothing with long sleeve shirt with sleeves down. 3. Operational flashing lights and reversing beepers on all plant.	Supervisor All Operator	**2**
General Safety Requirements	Personal injury to operator and other workers.	**1**	1. All persons who are to operate or assist with the operation of the Combination Vacuum Truck are to be fully competent with Type B Jetting Operators certificate and have received information and instruction in the safe use of the machine and the potential hazards. 2. Read all instructions before using machine. 3. Know how to stop and start the vacuum and bleed pressure quickly. 4. Be familiar with controls. 5. Do not work in rain or during thunderstorms. 6. The vacuum is not to be operated by children, teenagers or persons under the influence of drugs or alcohol. 7. Operator and assistant to wear appropriate PPE – safety boots, safety glasses, long clothing, safety vests (done up to prevent entanglement) gloves, hearing protection and safety helmets where required. 8. If the vacuum is to be used with hazardous or dangerous materials- the operator must be adequately trained. 9. If there is a need to climb on top of truck ref to Working at Hight SWMS.	Operator	**2**

DBYD Verification	Electrocution Explosion	**1**	1. Review all Dial Before You Digs including any conditions of work issued by the relevant asset owner. 2. Verify all underground assets has been located. 3. Locate or have your supervisor arrange the location any unidentified services. 4. Ensure Safe Operating Procedures (SOP) of the asset owner will be complied with regarding excavations. 5. Obtain any relevant excavation permits if the depth of the excavation is to exceed 1.5m. 6. If the above cannot be facilitated, please contact your supervisor immediately. 7. In the instance of contracting to a primary PCBU ensure they have DBYD on site (do not exceed 28 days from issue date) and all relevant locations have been located. 8. Once satisfied underground asset locations are known, proceed with works.	Supervisor All	**2**
	Falling or tripping over on site.	**2**	1. Maintain good housekeeping especially hoses. 2. Barricade off unsafe areas. 3. Clearly mark protruding objects using paint, caps or hazard tape. 4. Ensure open pits or manholes a guarded to prevent falling in.	Supervisor Operator	**3**
	Manual handling of vac hoses	**2**	1. Use boom where possible to move hose, shorten length of hose required, if possible, use correct manual handling techniques. 2. Must be a two-person operation to manage manual handling/fatigue risks.	Operators	**3**
Opening manholes/pits	Manual handling Open manholes/pits	**1**	1. Use correct tools to pen manholes/pits. 2. Place guard over open manhole/pit.	Operators	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Confined space		3. If working near open manhole/pit maintain three points of contact with hose and ground to prevent possibility of falling. 4. Follow Confined Space Entry SWMS when entry to confined space is required.		
Pre start checks vacuum recycler truck	Unsafe machine potential for injury to operator or bystanders	**1**	1. Prestart checks are to be completed as per the operations manual and documented as such.	Operator	2
Assemble the vacuum equipment	Manual handling Slips, trips, falls Failure of connections Kicking/moving hoses Vertical connections of hose People being caught on end of suction Static Electricity	**1**	1. Use boom where practical. 2. Position hose trailer as close to worksite as possible. 3. Use team lifting. 4. Use vacuum nozzles and fittings to reduce bending. 5. Each travis lamp to be checked and tapped if required. 6. Hose to be restrained along length to stop whipping. 7. Vertical connections to be tied between joints to prevent hose falling if clamp fails. 8. Personnel not to step over unrestrained hose lengths. 9. Barricade paths and work area. 10. Use crane or similar to raise/lower hose lengths where possible 11. Vertical connections to be secured with rope across join. 12. Area underneath and near vertical connections to be barricaded out to a distance to ensure no-one is underneath the potential fall path of hose if it fails. 13. Vacuum breaker must be fitted at final length of hose on worksite. 14. If remote is fitted then remote is also to be secured with Operator onsite. 15. Walk vacuum line to ensure safety & security along length of line to worksite. 16. Earth out the unit using the static cable and stake.	Operators	2
Assemble Jetting Equipment	Infection Sharp edges Manual handling Falling equipment High pressure water	**1**	1. Personal hygiene (wash hands prior to eating). 2. Wear gloves and remove sharp edges/burrs on equipment. 3. Use correct manual handling techniques. 4. Store equipment securely on vehicle. 5. Inspect hose daily and ensure it has been tested (6 monthly)	Operators	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			6. Never cap jetting hose. 7. Inspect jetting hose for damage. 8. Never adjust pump pressures or regulators. 9. Maximum reducer on 1 inch hose is ¾ inch. 10. No reducers on ½ inch hose. 11. Must be 3 metre leader hose on front of jetting assembly to identify end of jet assembly when removing from drain. 12. Fittings to be firmly secured use		
Operating the Vacuum recycler truck	Injury to operator or bystanders – high pressure- dirt and stones can be flicked around.	**1**	1. Wear eye and ear protection. 2. Keep operating area clear of all persons. 3. Use a witch's hat next to the water jet to prevent splashes. 4. Stay alert and beware of the force of the water pressure coming out the end of the hose and when using the vacuum hose be aware of the suction pressure. 5. Do not overreach or stand on unstable supports. 6. Never aim the jet in the direction of persons or animals as the water jet comes out of the nozzle at high speed with high pressure. 7. Do not leave the operating vacuum unattended. If the vacuum is not required switch off. 8. Do not operate the vacuum in enclosed spaces. 9. Follow directions as per the operations manual. 10. The pressure hose is operated with by trigger action. 11. When cleaning pipes etc. the hose must first be in the pipe prior to activating the trigger.	Operator	2
	Fire hazard	**1**	1. Do not use near flammable liquids. 2. Turn off machine prior to refueling.	Operators	**2**
Flushing and or vacuuming pits and pipes	Striking pedestrians, members of the public or other workers Spraying debris causing injury Spraying debris causing property damage	**1**	1. Wear appropriate PPE for the site including gloves. 2. Ensure appropriate work area is cordoned off to prevent access by the public. 3. When deciding on appropriate work area take into account spray return and wind conditions. 4. Observe the hose as it is being fed into pipe or pit. 5. Watch reel to ensure hose winds on correctly.	Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Whipping hoses		6. Ensure minimal slack in hose to prevent whipping. 7. Before hose leaves pit ensure the water is shut off. 8. Stand clear of hose when it is exiting pit or pipe as debris may be sprayed out. 9. Only uncover pits required for access as pit covers will prevent uncontrolled water or debris spray. 10. Never point pressure spray at any person.		
Use of drain cleaning cutter	Hand injury Bodily injury from cutting blade	**1**	1. Where possible investigate that drain obstructions are tree roots and are not other pipes, cables etc. using suitable equipment. 2. First run cleaner jetting head at obstruction. 3. If obstruction doesn't clear and roots are evident in water then cutting head can be prepared. 4. Wear gloves when handling cutting blade. 5. Do not operate cutter until safely positioned inside the drain. 6. Maintain a grip on jetting hose to feel the reaction force of cutter.	Operators	**2**
Non-Destructive Digging – Coring hard surfaces, post-hole or trench, prove asset	Flying debris Extreme Noise High pressure water Damage to lance Damage to Assets	**2**	1. Wear appropriate PPE. 2. Use double hearing protection (ear plugs & earmuffs) 3. Use Noise Dampening Box. 4. Do not allow the water jet to contact any body part. 5. DO NOT strike or force soil using the lance. 6. Use other tools to lift loosened or exposed soil/debris from hole. 7. Once an asset or marker tape is discovered slow digging process and steadily reveal the asset.	Operators	**3**
Hose blockage	Entrapped hand Manual handling	**2**	1. Do not use hand to unblock hoses. 2. Keep hands clear of hose. 3. Use two operators when handling hose when clearing blockages.	Operators	**3**
Finishing	Waste not cleaned up Manual Handling Slips, trips, falls	**2**	1. Ensure all waste is vacuumed up. 2. Use correct manual handling techniques. 3. Ensure manhole or pits are covered.	Operators	**3**
Shut down and Maintenance	Potential for personal injury	**1**	1. When finishing work follow end of day maintenance and shut down requirements. 2. When disassembling any part of the machine or servicing make sure the machine is turned off.	Operator	**2**

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	**Hazard**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class after Controls in place**
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	**1**	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers are available in WHS 05 emergency procedures. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	**2**
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	**2**	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	**3**
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	**2**	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	**3**
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	**2**	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	**3**
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	**1**	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	**2**
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	**1**	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	**2**

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	**2**	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tires/bodies for buildu p of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	**3**
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	**1**	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled, and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	**2**
Visual Impact **Litter and Amenities** **Waste Management**	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	**2**	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	**3**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat at all Times	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle License's (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators license's or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice and Other Guides			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure Water Jetting – Safe Work Aust 2012			

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Vacuum Recycler Truck
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

PANELTEC PTY LTD

PO Box 148 Kings Meadows, TAS 7249
ABN: 12 128 689 412

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WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.